

Slack Configuration in OpenClaw — Step-by-Step Guide

This guide describes the process of configuring Slack as a communication channel in OpenClaw.

The objective is to allow the agent to receive and respond to messages directly in Slack channels using Socket Mode, without the need to expose a public endpoint.

1. Create the application in Slack

Access the Slack development dashboard and create a new application.

Define:

Application name: openclaw

Then select the workspace where the application will be installed.

This application will be responsible for connecting Slack to OpenClaw.

2. Enable Socket Mode

In the Slack application side menu, open: Socket Mode

Enable the option 'Enable Socket Mode'.

Socket Mode allows OpenClaw to receive events from Slack through a secure WebSocket connection, without needing to configure public endpoints.

3. Generate the App-Level Token

In the side menu open: Basic Information

Scroll down until you find the section: App-Level Tokens

Click: Generate Token and Scopes

You will see a window requesting:

Token Name: use a descriptive name, for example 'openclaw-socket'

Scope: click 'Add Scope' and select 'connections:write'

Then generate the token.

The token will have the format: xapp-...

This is the App-Level Token used by Socket Mode to establish the connection between Slack and OpenClaw.

4. Obtain the Bot Token

In the Slack side menu open: OAuth & Permissions

Install the application in the workspace.

After installation copy the token shown in the section 'Bot User OAuth Token'.

This token will have the format: xoxb-...

This is the token that allows the bot to send and receive messages in Slack.

4.1 Configure bot permissions in Slack

In OAuth & Permissions, inside 'Bot Token Scopes', add:

- app_mentions:read
- channels:history
- channels:read
- chat:write

These permissions allow OpenClaw to:

- read messages from channels
- detect when the bot is mentioned
- respond to messages in Slack

After adding scopes click again: Install to Workspace.

4.2 Enable bot events

In the Slack application menu open: Event Subscriptions

Enable the option: Enable Events

In 'Subscribe to bot events' add:

- app_mention
- message.channels

These events allow the bot to:

- detect when someone mentions the bot
- receive messages sent in the channel

4.3 Add the bot to the channel

Even with the application installed in the workspace, the bot will not respond in a channel until it is invited.

Open your test channel (example: #openclaw-test) and run:

```
/invite @openclaw
```

or

```
/invite @your-bot-name
```

4.4 Test communication with the bot

Send a test message mentioning the bot:

```
@openclaw hello
```

If everything is configured correctly:

- the event will be sent via Socket Mode
- OpenClaw will receive the message
- the agent will respond in the channel

5. Run the OpenClaw onboarding

Run in the terminal: `openclaw onboard`

This starts the interactive wizard that configures:

- gateway
- authentication
- communication channels
- initial system configuration

6. Configure Slack in the wizard

During onboarding choose Slack as the communication channel.

The wizard will ask: Configure Slack channels access?

Choose: Yes

7. Define channel access

Slack channels access options:

- Allowlist (recommended)

- Open (allow all channels)
- Disabled (block all channels)

Recommended option: Allowlist

8. Define allowed channels

When prompted: Slack channels allowlist (comma-separated)

Enter the channel allowed to use the bot.

Example: #openclaw-test or openclaw-test

9. Create a test channel in Slack

Create a dedicated public channel for tests.

Example: openclaw-test

Add the openclaw application to the channel.

10. Difference between application and channel

openclaw — Slack application — integration with OpenClaw

openclaw-test — Slack channel — place where the bot operates

11. Using channel names during onboarding

During onboarding it is possible to use the channel name directly.

Channel ID is not mandatory.

Example: #openclaw_test2

12. Security best practices

For a safe initial setup:

- Use Socket Mode
- Limit channels with Allowlist
- Use a dedicated test channel
- Store tokens securely

Advanced setups may also use:

- Slack User ID for administrator control
- Channel ID inside PERMISSIONS.md

Conclusion

After these steps OpenClaw will be connected to Slack and ready to receive commands in the configured channel.

This integration allows Slack to function as a direct interface to interact with the OpenClaw agent system.

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